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- Official floor video (House of Delegates archive, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_KWBR2Td928
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[00:13:42] The House will come to order. Members, please take your seats. Yeah. Head page. The House is now in session. All persons not entitled to privileges of the floor, please retire to the gallery.

[00:13:59] The members will rise and be led in prayer by Reverend Kyle Dobbins, Senior Pastor, Taylorsville Baptist Church, Doswell, and remain standing for the Pledge of Allegiance to the United States of America, which will be led by the Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Join me in prayer. Almighty God, we give you thanks for this moment to pause in prayer, connecting with you, our Maker and our Lord.

[00:14:22] I am confident, God, that you are in this place. Lord, it may perhaps feel like a mundane Monday in the midst of a busy session, and still, this is the day, Lord, that you have made, and we rejoice and are glad in it. May we always have eyes that search for you, and may we seek your will to be done.

[00:14:43] Lord, I am grateful for each elected official who has accepted the weighty responsibility to serve in this body on behalf of the men and women across our commonwealth. We are thankful for them. I pray, Lord, for your peace, for your comfort, for your love to surround these delegates and their teams.

[00:15:01] May they find strength and endurance in you, Lord, as they seek to lead and as they collaborate with others to make decisions. May they find wisdom and clarity in you. May we always, God, as your word

says, may we be quick to listen and slow to speak.

[00:15:19] Lord, your word says that you delight in us, that you even rejoice over us in singing. What a gift it is to know that. Lord, I ask that you would bless this commonwealth. Lord, bless the servicemen and women who protect and serve our nation so selflessly. We ask God for a hedge of protection over them.

[00:15:37] God, I ask that you would watch over this house of delegates. May your name be praised. And may all Virginians be served and strengthened by the work done in this assembly. We give you thanks. Amen. Amen. I pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America, to the republic for which it stands, one nation, under God, indivisible, liberty, and justice.

[00:16:12] The members will answer the roll call by indicating their presence on the electronic voting board.

[00:16:31] Clerk will close the roll. Mr. Speaker, quorum is present. Pursuant to House Rule 3, I've examined and approved the General House of Delegates for Friday, February 27, 2026. Most of the resolutions under Rule 39 pursuant to the provisions of Rule 40 are now in order. Does the clerk have any announcements or communications?

[00:16:48] A few communications, Mr. Speaker. The Senate has insisted on its amendments and requested committees of conference on the following legislation. House Bills 6, 125, 276, 396, 584, 705, and House Bill 1278.

[00:17:05] Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House accede to the request of the Senate and appoint a committee of conference on the previously reported legislation. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring moves that the House accede to the Senate's request for committees of conference on the previously announced legislation.

[00:17:22] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Ms. Speaker, another communication. The Senate has rejected the House amendments to the following legislation. Senate Bills 44, 94, 134, 140, 226, 324, 388, as well as Senate Bill 648.

[00:17:43] Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House insists on its amendments and requests committees of conference on the previously reported legislation. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring moves that the House insists on the previously announced legislation and insist on a committee of conference. All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no.

[00:18:00] Motion is agreed to. Ms. Speaker, members of the House, proceed to House Rule 40. The Speaker request to use your request to speak button for the agenda items listed for reference during this first portion of the morning are up on the voting board. The Delegate from Hanover, Delegate Fowler.

[00:18:17] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Members of the House, opening today's session with prayers, Pastor Kyle Dibbons from Taylorsville Baptist Church in Diveswell, Virginia.

[00:18:35] Pastor Kyle and his wife Lisa have a growing family that includes daughter Naomi, age 6 and twin, 9-month-old boys Jonah and Silas. Mr. Speaker, you can feel the history as soon as you step foot into the beautiful sanctuary at Taylorsville Baptist Church.

[00:18:54] The church has been a community staple in Hanover County since its founding in 1841, celebrating 180 years as one of the oldest churches in Virginia. The original house of worship, the

Taylorsville Meeting House, was used until the present-day brick building was built in 1856.

[00:19:14] Mr. Speaker, the Taylorsville Baptist Church has laid a solid foundation on which current generations and generations to come continue the rich history and heritage of their church. Taylorsville Baptist is a community of faith that believes that all are sinners and all are children of God who come together to experience God through worship and through one another.

[00:19:41] Ms. Speaker, members of the House, please join me in giving a warm welcome to Pastor Dobbins. Thank you. Welcome to the Capitol, Pastor Dobbins, and thank you for that heartfelt prayer this morning.

[00:20:05] The Delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Carr. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. The Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Joining us today in the House Gallery are students from the Virginia History Day program, and I would ask the group to please stand. These students from elementary, middle, and high schools all across the Commonwealth represented Virginia at the prestigious National History Day competition last June, an honor earned by winning at the state level contest. All these exceptional young people

[00:20:43] undertook extensive historical research on important topics through the Virginia Day History program hosted by the Virginia Museum of History and Culture. Virginia History Day is the state affiliate of the National History Day, a nationwide history research project competition for students grades 6 through 12, similar to a science fair, but for history. This program reaches more than 8,000 students across the Commonwealth each year. Some of the fascinating topics these students studied include an exhibit on women's suffrage history, a website about a

[00:21:20] case that challenged segregation in Virginia schools, a documentary about the development of IVF technologies, a performance about plastic and pollution, as well as many other fascinating projects. I hope the body will join me in giving these remarkable students and the future leaders and stewards of our shared history. A warm house welcome. Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:21:54] Delegate from Rockingham, Delegate Runyon. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today, the livestock production and veterinary and science students from Valley Career and Technical Education in Augusta County are visiting the house floor to better understand the vital connection between agriculture and government. I ask them to please stand and be recognized. These students are gaining hands-on experience in animal science, herd health, biosecurity, food safety, and responsible

[00:22:31] livestock management while preparing for careers that support Virginia's largest industry, agriculture. Through their coursework and FFA involvement, they are learning not only the science behind animal care, but also the policies, regulations, and leadership decisions that impact farmers, veterinarians, and rural communities across the Commonwealth. Their visit today allows them to see firsthand how legislation influences agriculture and to better understand the role as future industry leaders and informed citizens. I ask my House colleagues to please join me in

[00:23:04] giving these students a warm House welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. The Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, I have the distinct

honor and privilege to introduce to some and reacquaint with others a distinguished gentleman and a great

[00:23:35] Virginian, one whose life has been shaped, molded by leadership, public service, and an unwavering commitment to justice. That is, retired circuit court judge and former member of this body, the Honorable Kenneth R. Melvin. Mr. Speaker, Judge Melvin was first elected to the Virginia

[00:24:14] House of Delegates in 1991, representing the citizens of Portsmouth and the surrounding Hampton Roads community. He served in this chamber with distinction for a decade from 1992 to 2002 and earned the respect of colleagues on both sides of the aisle through his thoughtful leadership and dedication to his constituents. Mr. Speaker, I heard from a great source, the delegate from Hampton, that he had an extraordinary, peculiar talent on the floor.

[00:24:47] Mr. Speaker, members had to always be checking the list and checking it twice. He was the only delegate that could have your bill killed on third read, uncontested calendar. That earned him the nickname the assassin following his legislative service he continued his commitment to the commonwealth when he was elected to the general assembly to serve on the portsmouth circuit court or by the general assembly to serve on the portsmouth circuit court where he presided with

[00:25:24] fairness wisdom and integrity today he joins us and certainly his support over the years has been from his wife sylvia and that has been an important part of his journey throughout his career whether as a legislator, jurist, attorney, or community leader, he has remained a tireless advocate for the rule of law, equal justice, and an opportunity for all Virginians.

[00:25:50] Mr. Speaker, today we are honored to welcome back to this house a respected former colleague, a distinguished jurist, and a true servant of the common world. I ask that we please join me as we extend to him a warm house welcome.

[00:26:06] Welcome back, Judge Melvin. And it is my distinct honor to be able to walk in your footsteps and serve in the district that you served.

[00:26:29] I'm so proud to be a mentor, mentee of yours. And obviously, I inherited a great legacy from you. So thank you for everything that you've done. The delegate from James City County, Delegate Anderson.

[00:26:46] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for the purpose of an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, with us in the gallery is Inner Peace Coalition, a James City County non-profit, and I would ask them to please stand for recognition. The coalition's work is built upon three foundational pillars, economic development, affordable housing, and tangible resources.

[00:27:09] Driven by the core philosophy that true inner peace begins with the fulfillment of essential needs, their mission is to ensure that every member of our own community can eat. As a catalyst for economic equity, Interpeace Coalition has empowered over 300 minority women and veteran-owned businesses to scale and succeed.

[00:27:28] Alongside business growth, the coalition provides housing, opportunities, and critical support for vulnerable populations, fueled by a visionary network of community collaborators and partners. Their commitment to community resilience was recognized nationally when the founders received the prestigious 2024 U.S. Small Business Administration Legacy Business Award.

[00:27:49] and we are privileged to have several of the organization's members, partners, and participants join us in the gallery today. I hope you will join me in giving the Inner Peace Coalition a warm house welcome. Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:28:10] Delegate from Arlington, Delegate Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise with a motion. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'd like to re-refer on page 13, SB 464, back to the Committee on Agriculture, I speak, and Natural Resources.

[00:28:27] Delegate from Arlington, Delegate Lopez moved that we refer SB 464 back to the Committee on Agriculture and Natural Resources found on page 13. All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. SB 464 is re-referred to the Committee on Agriculture.

[00:28:43] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an announcement. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, some of you have already noticed that in the back room, you'll see the product of my and my wife's hard work together. We baked over 100 of these triangular pastries.

[00:29:02] They're called hamantaschen. And we did that because tonight at sundown is the beginning of the Jewish festival called Purim. Purim is a great holiday. It's one of my favorites. It's a very festive holiday. We celebrate things. So hamantaschen literally translates to Haman's Hats or Haman's Pockets. For those of you who don't know who Haman is, Haman is the bad guy in the Book of Esther.

[00:29:20] He was one of the king's regents in ancient Shushan. And he had a lot of authority due to his proximity to power. He got kind of full of himself, walked around making a lot of decrees, and wanted people to bow down to him. The hero of the story is a fellow named Mordecai, who said, no, I only bow down to God.

[00:29:37] I won't bow down to you, Haman. Haman got mad, said, if that's the case, I'm going to kill not just you, but all the Jews in Shushan. The good news is Queen Esther came and saved the day, because the king was kind of erratic. Sort of the last person in his ear was the last person that got what they wanted, and she convinced him to save all the Jews. And so we celebrate that by eating these Haman's hats, which we have in the back.

[00:29:56] I will tell you, I've been trying to do this, I've been trying to remember to do this for a long time as a member of the General Assembly. This is my 13th session. I finally remembered on my 13th session to do it and actually bring them to closing, which is kind of funny because 13 is an important date in Purim as well. It was the 13th day of Adar that the Jews were saved.

[00:30:13] I actually now represent the 13th district. I didn't do that when I was in the beginning. I finally remembered. So it's kind of spooky there. One last thing I'll say about Purim, there's another tradition, which is that you are supposed to and this is actually in the Talmud you're supposed to drink so much that you can't by the end of the evening you can't tell the difference between the name Mordecai and the name Haman and so for anybody who wants to join me this evening we'll be working on that aspect of the holiday as well thank you Mr. Speaker I hope you all enjoy the uh enjoy the cookies. Delegate from Norfolk

[00:30:49] Delegate Anthony. Thank you Mr. Speaker I rise for a motion. Delegate has the floor. Thank you Mr. Speaker, I move that House Joint Resolution 170 on page 22 of today's calendar go by until March 10th. Delegate from Norfolk, Delegate Anthony moves that House Joint Resolution 170 found on page 22 go by until March 10th. 10th. All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. House Resolution 170 goes by

until March 10th. Delegate from James City County, Delegate Anderson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for two motions. The delegate has the floor. Thank you,

[00:31:26] Mr. Speaker, I move that House Resolution number 161 on page 29 of the calendar be moved to Thursday, March 5th. Delicate from James City Council, Deputy Anderson moves that House Resolution 161 found on page 29 and go by until March 5th. All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. 161 is by until March 5th. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. My second motion is I move House Resolution 184 on page 31 of the calendar to Tuesday, tomorrow, March 2nd. March 3rd. Delicate

[00:32:04] from James City Council moves that House Resolution 184 go by until March 3rd. All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Clerk will announce the next order of business. Second portion of the morning hours, announcement of member requests for legislation to be moved from the uncontested calendar to the regular.

[00:32:21] There are five in that first category when we get down to business. Senate Bill's third reading uncontested delegate, excuse me, Senator French's, Senator Stewart's, SB 386, over to the regular calendar, page 6. Senator Deeds, SB 527, out of the block, over to the regular calendar, page 7.

[00:32:42] Senator Craig's, SB 659, out of the block, to the regular calendar, page 8. Senator Jones's, SB 729, out of the block, to the regular calendar. And finally, on page 9, Senator Suterlein's, SB 820. Those five are out of the block, over to the regular calendar.

[00:32:58] Clerk will announce the next auto bill. Third portion of the morning hour, reserved for the announcement of member requests of legislation to buy for the day and a subsequent motion by the Majority Leader to effectuate that. There are two, that category on page 10 of the printed calendar, Senate Bill's third regular, Senator Rouse's SB 661, buy for the day, the request of Delegate Tran.

[00:33:19] And in the category on page 17 of House Bills with Senate Amendments, Delegate Carnegie, excuse me, HB 312 is by for the day. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the legislation as announced by the clerk go by for the day.

[00:33:37] Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring moves that the legislation as announced by the clerk go by for the day. As many in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. The clerk will announce the next order. And the fourth and final portion of the morning hour is reserved for member requests for points of personal privilege. Kindly use your request speak button to get into the queue.

[00:33:54] Calendar for today, Monday, March 2nd, for the Virginia House of Delegates, page one of the printed calendar. First category that's live is Senate Bills on third reading, final passage, and the uncontested calendar block.

[00:34:10] We begin with Senate Bill 33, which is legislation to amend and reenact the Code of Virginia and landing programs for at-risk students' permissible use of funding. The legislation was reported to the Committee on Education. Delegate from Richmond, Delegate McQuinn. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:34:27] Mr. Speaker, Senate Bill 33 is incarnate to my House Bill 195. It passed the House of 96-0. This bill just adds specific language about supporting students' physical and mental health. It adds RNs and APRNs to the list of approved expenditures for the at-risk add-on.

[00:34:47] I hope it will be the will of the body to pass Senate Bill 33. Next up in the uncontested block is Senate Bill 87. Legislation to amend the Code of Virginia relating to local government sporting events and sporting facilities. Automated external defibrillators. Legislation reporting committee on county, cities, and towns. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer.

[00:35:04] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, Senate Bill 87 simply says that local governments have to have AEDs at sporting events to save somebody if they have a heart attack. I hope it's a well-bodied to pass the bill. Continuing with the block, Senate Bill 163.

[00:35:19] Now, before you seek to amend and reenact a section in the Code of Virginia related to pesticide control, agencies of persons exempt or partially exempt. Legislation report, committee on agriculture, Chesapeake, and natural resources. Delica Mollet and Delica Lopez. Mr. Speaker, if I could take that by for the moment, I'm having a technical issue.

[00:35:43] Drinking too much next to Simons. Temporarily, sir. Move it by temporarily. This beat 163 will go by temporarily. Continuing with the block on page 3, we come to Senate Bill 197, which seeks to amend and reenact the Section Code of Virginia related to the Virginia Community Flood Preparedness Fund, Loan and Grant Program, Deferment of Interest, Recruel, and Repayment Obligations.

[00:36:05] Legislation is particularly on appropriations. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Cresick. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. members of the body. This bill is a recommendation of the Joint Subcommittee on Recurrent Flooding. It ensures that funds disbursed through the Virginia Community Flood Preparedness Fund for flood prevention, protection projects, and studies are not subject to interest accrual and repayment obligations until completion of the project or study. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. Senate Bill 245, now before you, seeks to amend the Code of Virginia land or social media platforms, school boards, artificial intelligence systems, civil penalties. Legislation report committee on education with amendments. Delegate from Roanoke, Delegate Rasul. Mr. Speaker, move

[00:36:44] the committee amendments. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. Delegate from Roanoke, Delegate Rasul. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Ladies and gentlemen of the House, what Senate Bill 245 simply says is that you can't use social media as a sole means for communicating certain information with students. I hope it would be a pleasure to body to pass the bill. Over on page four, we come to Senate Bill 308, which would direct the Department of Health to develop a Strategic Plan for Opioid Response to Reduced Rates of Drug Overdose and Drug Overdose Deaths in the Commonwealth.

[00:37:14] Legislative report to the Committee on Health and Human Services. The Amendment and Nature Substitutes will be reported by the Committee on Appropriation. Delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Reeser. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the HHS Committee Substitute. Shall the Committee Substitute be agreed? To all those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The Committee Substitute is agreed to. The Delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Reeser.

[00:37:31] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This bill is accognite to my HB 794, which passed the House uncontested. It directs the Virginia Department of Health to lead a strategic statewide plan to address opioid overdoses and deaths. I move that the bill pass. Bottom of page four, we come to Senate Bill 383, which seeks to amend and reenact Section of the Code of Virginia and the Board of Agriculture and Consumer Services, invasive plant species installation, written notification to property owners, civil penalty.

[00:37:59] Legislature report quickly on agriculture, Chesapeake, and natural resources. Delicate from Arlington, Delicate Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. SB 383 from Senator French was the cognate of legislation that was identical to Delegate Pence's bill, HB 710, which reported from ACNR by a vote of 22 to nothing and passed the House 95 to 2 to 0.

[00:38:21] It basically provides that the Board of Agriculture and Consumer Services may assess a civil penalty in an amount of not more than $250 for the first violation, $500 for the second, and $1,000 for each subsequent violation of any tradesperson involved with proposing or installing plants who fail to provide written notification to property owners that they are invasive.

[00:38:38] Mr. Speaker, I move that we pass the bill. Senate Bill 386 is out of the block over to the regular calendar. Therefore, continuing third reading, uncontested block, Senate Bill 390 before you now. Seeks to amend and reenact multiple sections of the Code of Virginia and repeal others, all relating to the Apple Board.

[00:38:53] Repeal legislation reporting on agricultural Chesapeake Natural Resources. Delegate from Arlington, Delegate Lopez. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, Senate Bill 390 is the cognate of HB 65, which terminates the Apple board.

[00:39:13] I hope it's the will of the body to pass the bill. Over on page 6, continuing with the block, we come to Senate Bill 522, which seeks to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia relating to the Office of Working Lands Preservation, Powers and Duties for Sustainability Fund. Legislation reporting, again, from the Committee on Agricultural, Chesapeake, and Natural Resources.

[00:39:32] Delic from Arlington, Delic Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. 522 from Senator Williams Graves is identical to HB 543, which reported from ACNR by 22 to nothing. It passed the House 98 to nothing. It adds management of the Forest Sustainability Fund to the powers and duties of the Office of Working Lands Preservation with the Department of Forestry. I move that we pass the bill.

[00:39:54] Senate Bill 527 on the printed calendar is over to the regular calendar, continuing with the block. Uncontested is now before you as Senate Bill 640, which seeks to amend and reenact various portions of the Code of Virginia, repeal several others, all related to the Department of Social Services, corrective actions plan, centralized hotline for reports or complaints of child abuse or neglect. Legislation reported on the Committee on Health and Human Services, Amendment 8 substitutes, such as reported by the Committee on Approves.

[00:40:18] Delegate from Fairfax. Delegate Tran. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'd like to move the House adopt the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I substituted Senate Bill 640 now. is identical to my House Bill 1490, which passed the House 89-7 and to Delegate Coulson's House Bill 1366, which passed 91-6. It establishes a statewide centralized intake and validity determination process for reports of child abuse and neglect. It requires a 24-hour response to those reports. It also grants the Commissioner of Social Services the authority to step in

[00:40:56] and provide temporary state intervention in certain circumstances. I move passage of the bill uh senate bill 659 is out of the block to the regular calendar top of page eight next bill in this block is senate bill 719 which seeks to amend to go to virginia related to the secretary of agriculture and forestry virginia farm and forest prosperity plan report legislation again reported committee on agriculture

chesapeake and natural resources the delegate from dinwiddie delegate pope adams thank you mr speaker sb 719 is identical to my hb 512 which passed the house 98 to zero and establishes the first ever comprehensive strategic plan to support the prosperity of farming and forestry. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass.

[00:41:35] Senate Bill 729 is out of the block. Continuing with the block now before you is Senate Bill 771, which seeks to amend and reenact a section of the Code of Virginia related to workers' compensation, burial expenses, annual adjustment, legislation reporting committee on appropriations.

[00:41:50] Doug from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 771 increases the amount required to be paid by an employer under workers' compensation provisions for burial expenses from $10,000 to $15,000. The bill has a delayed enactment of July 1, 2028. I move that we pass the bill.

[00:42:11] Next up in the block, Senate Bill 784. As legislation amended and reenacted Section of the Code of Virginia relating to groundwater management areas, bioslurry injections in wells prohibited. Legislation again reports to the Committee on Agricultural Stress Beacon, Natural Resources. The Delegate for Mackermack, Delegate Blockson.

[00:42:27] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 1381 is identical to Senate Bill 784. It basically restricts reverse fracking when it goes to a groundwater management area. I hope it's the pleasure of the body to pass the bill. Senate Bill 820 is out of the block.

[00:42:43] Next up in the block is Senate Bill 822, which seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to school nurses' sickle cell disease training. This legislation report committee on education. -Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Sowell. -Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:42:59] School nurses are the most important healthcare professional in some students' lives. Children all across Virginia depend on their school nurses when they fall ill or feel hurt. Sickle cell anemia can cause significant pain and health problems for people with the disease. This legislation is identical to my House Bill 1446, which passed with unanimous support.

[00:43:17] It requires the school nurses' complete training recognize the signs of sickle cell disease. I move the bill to pass. Man, I love killing it. And returning to page two of the printing calendar, picking up the bill we took by temporarily a moment ago, Senate Bill 163 rounds out this block, seeks to amend and reenact a portion of the Code of Virginia related to pesticide control, agencies of persons exempt or partially exempt, legislation supports committee on ACNR.

[00:43:44] From Arlington, Delegate Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. SB 163 from Senator McDougall, reported out of ACNR 22 to nothing, and then was reported this bill, Mr. Speaker, deals with pesticide control and provides that volunteers associated with state agencies, municipal corporations, or other governmental agencies shall be certified as commercial applicators or registered technicians for the use of pesticides, provided that such certification is valid when applying or supervising application of pesticides.

[00:44:09] I move that we pass the bill. Shall the bills pass? Close the rope. Ayes, 98, noes, 0.

[00:44:26] Ayes, 98, noes, 0. The bills pass. Over on page 10, the printing calendar, new category, Senate Bill's on third reading, final passage, but regular calendar. Senate Bill 661 is by for the day. So the first of the dozen and a half bills in this new category, we start with Senate Bill 63, legislation amend and reenact portion of the Code of Virginia relating to the Board of Education requirements for graduation with an

advanced studies diploma, simultaneous completion of international baccalaureate diploma, and Advanced Studies Diploma approval of alternatives for certain credit requirements, regulations, legislation reporting on education.

[00:45:00] Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Simons. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, SB63 is the cognate to my HB 595 and allows the Board of Education to approve equivalent coursework and recognize the IB diploma as meeting Virginia's Advanced Studies Diploma requirements.

[00:45:17] I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 96, nos 3.

[00:45:34] Ayes 96, Noes 3. The delegate from Alexander, Delegate Heron. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a motion. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Having voted on the prevailing side on which we passed a group of bills and third uncontested reading, I move that we reconsider the vote so that a member can cast her vote.

[00:45:53] Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Heron moves that, having voted on the prevailing side by which we passed the uncontested block, to allow another member who was sitting in their seat who did not vote to vote. All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. Motion is agreed to.

[00:46:10] Shall the bills pass? Ayes, 99. No, 0. Ayes, 99. No, 0. The bills pass. Over on page 11, we continue third reading regular with Senate Bill 89.

[00:46:32] SB 89, 6th Amendment, reenacted sections of the code of Virginia relating to powers of service districts, control of invasive plant species. Again, Legislature Report, Committee on Agriculture, Chesapeake, and Natural Resources. Deidre from Albemarle, Deidre Cosa. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 89 is the Cognitive to My House Bill 388 that passed this House 90 to 8.

[00:46:50] As a reminder, it allows public service districts the ability to control invasive plants. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? Close the roll.

[00:47:09] Ayes 92, noes 6. Ayes 92, noes 6. The bill passes. Senate Bill 109 is legislation that seeks to amend and reenact Section Code of Virginia In relating to school board policies, parental notifications, safe storage of prescription drugs and firearms in households.

[00:47:28] Legislature report committee on education with amendments. And Delegate Cohen has a floor substitute, amendment nature of substitute, which is available to the public and to the members here electronically. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Cohen. Mr. Speaker, first, I move the amendments from the House Education Committee and ask the body to reject them.

[00:47:50] Shall the committee amendment be agreed? For all those in favor, say aye. Those opposed, no. No. Committee amendment is rejected. Thank you. Next, I ask that the House adopt the floor substitute. Shall the floor substitute be agreed?

[00:48:08] For all those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The floor substitute is agreed to the delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Cohen. Thank you. With the substitute, now this bill is finally conformed to my HB 201, which has passed both chambers and is headed to the governor. And this change has the support of the Senate patron.

[00:48:26] I'd ask that the bill please pass. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Excuse me, ayes 64, noes 35.

[00:48:43] Ayes 64, noes 35, the bill passes. Over on page 12, we come to Senate Bill 151, which seeks to amend the Code of Virginia related to the Board of Education, programs and courses of instruction, water safety instruction for elementary school students required, Guidelines for legislation reporting on education with an amendment nature of substitute that from Chesapeake Delegate Hayes Thank You mr. Speaker I move the committee substitute shall the committee substitute be agreed to all those in favor say aye All those opposed no the committee substitutes agreed to the delegate from Chesapeake Delegate Hayes Thank You mr. Speaker Senate bill 151 is the cognate of my house bill 705 which passed this chamber 82 to 16 and instructs the Board of Education to develop

[00:49:22] guidelines for instruction on water safety amongst elementary school students. Mr. Speaker, I move that we pass the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[00:49:42] Ayes, 82, noes, 17. Ayes, 82, noes, 17. The bill passes. Senate Bill 181 is legislation to amend and reenact Section of Code of Virginia relating to a real property tax partial exemption for repurposing underutilized structures for residential use, local incentives, legislation reporting committee on finance with an amendment nature substitute. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Watts. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitutes agree to. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Watts. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 181 allows localities to use a reduced real estate tax rate as an

[00:50:21] incentive to converting retail, commercial, or religious use to residential use with at least That's 30% of the residents having incomes below 80% of the area median income. It also contains a rollback provision so that the taxes could be recovered for after five, excuse me, five-year rollback if the use changes.

[00:50:48] I hope it will be the pleasure of the body to adopt, to pass the bill. Shall the bill pass?

[00:51:01] Book will close the roll. Ayes 70, nos 29. Ayes 70, nos 29. The bill passes. Over on page 13 of the printed calendar, we come to Senate Bill 186. This is legislation to amend and reenact different sections of the Code of Virginia. This time relating to misbranded meat food products prohibited.

[00:51:18] Civil penalty. Legislation reported committee on agriculture, Chesapeake, and natural resources. Kelly from Norfolk, David Glass. Gratitude, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 186 is about labeling meat right, labeling it true. It is a cognit to House Bill 322, and if labeling correctly is not your cup of tea, you can pay a civil fee.

[00:51:39] I move the bill pass. So the bill pass.

[00:51:55] The clip will close the row. Ayes 97, noes 2. Ayes 97, noes 2. The bill pass. Senate Bill 344 seeks to amend and reenact Section of the Code of Virginia related to the Department of Wildlife Resources, Premature separation and hybridization of mammalian wildlife, prohibited exceptions, legislation, workability on agriculture, Chesapeake, and natural resources.

[00:52:16] That is from Albemarle. I delegate law firm. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 344 is identical to my House Bill 112, which passed the House 71 to 27. And the clerk read it exactly right. So, Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass?

[00:52:34] Yeah. Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 74, noes 25. I-74, Nose 25, the bill passes. Senate Bill 464 is not before you, so continuing with third reading regular, we come over to page 14 of the printed calendar.

[00:52:56] Senate Bill 490 is legislation that would direct the Department of Housing and Community Development in collaboration with Virginia Housing Development Authority to create a two-year pilot program that would provide loan origination and servicing activities for mixed-income housing. Report legislation was reported clearly on appropriation with the amendment nature of a substitute.

[00:53:14] Delegate Helmer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, this is the cognate of my House Bill 820, which provides a facility to enable mixed income housing development. Pass the House on February 5th in a vote of 90 to 6th, and I move the committee substitute.

[00:53:29] Shall the committee substitute bill agree to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. I move passage of the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:53:48] Ayes 67, noes 32. Ayes 67, noes 32. The bill passes. Senate Bill 553 is legislating to amend and re-enact a section of the Code of Virginia relating to certain data from water users, water users, excuse me, water use consumption of data centers.

[00:54:06] Legislation reported from the Committee on Aircraft, Chesapeake, National Resources, amendment to substitute. Delegate from Arlington, Delegate Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee to substitute. Shall the committee to substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee to substitute is agreed to the delegate from Arlington, Delegate Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. SB 553 now conforms to Delegate Guzman's HB 496, which would authorize localities to require proposed data center facilities to submit annual water consumption estimates in consideration of water consumption from public resources when making permit decisions. I move that we pass the bill.

[00:54:36] Shall the bill pass? So we'll close the roll. Ayes, 81, noes, 18. Ayes, 81, noes, 18. The bill passes.

[00:54:52] Senate Bill 685, now before you, seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to standards of quality, school board policies, communication, and language accessibility for limited English proficient parents. Requirements report. Legislation reporting for UNL education with the amendment nature of a substitute.

[00:55:08] The delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Russell. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. The delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Russell. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. You're now Senate Bill 685 conforms to House Bill 1278, which requires school boards to develop and implement accessible location on its website for language policies.

[00:55:34] I hope it would be the pleasure of the body to pass the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 66, noes 33.

[00:55:51] Ayes 66, noes 33. The bill passes. Top of page 15, Senate Bill 707, now before you, seeks to amend and re-enact Section of the Code of Virginia relating to devocalization of dogs prohibited. Legislation report committee on agriculture, Chesapeake, and natural resources. Delicator from Arlington, Delicator Lopez.

[00:56:09] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Delicator, SB 707 reported from House ACNR by a vote of 19 to 3. This bill makes it unlawful for any person engaged in the practice of veterinary medicine to perform a surgical

devocalization procedure on a dog, except when such procedure is necessary to treat or relieve any injury, disease, or congenital defect that is causing or may cause the dog physical pain or harm.

[00:56:30] Mr. Speaker, I move we pass the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 89, noes 10.

[00:56:47] Ayes 89, noes 10. The bill passes. Senate Bill 724 seeks to amend and reenact the Section Code of Virginia relating to high school graduation requirements and diploma pathways. Implementation. Legislative workability on education. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:57:03] Senate Bill 724 is similar to a bill, House Bill 1283, which we passed, which just basically says what you're expected to do when you come in as a 9th grader. That'll stay the same all the way through graduation. It'll be a pleasure to the body to pass the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:57:29] Ayes 95, nos 2. Ayes 95, nos 2. The bill passes. Senate Bill 802 now before you seeks to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia related to clean energy and community flood preparedness, market-based trading programs, legislation reporting on agriculture, Tespeak, and natural resources.

[00:57:46] Delia from Alexander, Delia Herring. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, Senate Bill 802 is a cognate to my House Bill 397. The bill directs the Virginia Department of Environmental Quality to take all necessary steps for Virginia to rejoin the regional greenhouse gas initiative.

[00:58:02] I move that the bill passed. Delia from Akamak, Delegate Bloxham. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I don't mean to slow the train down a little bit, but I did want to rise to speak to the bill. On the eastern shore, we have a saying. If it quacks like a duck, if it walks like a duck, swims like a duck, it's a duck.

[00:58:19] Just eastern shore, huh? Eastern shore. So my issue isn't with so-called tax on this. If you're going to call it a tax, call it a tax. Let's set the rate, put it on the electric bill, and put it.

[00:58:38] Understand that my area, I represent in Norfolk, they need $2.1 billion to do their projects. Virginia Beach needs over $800 million. They bonded it to do resiliency projects.

[00:58:54] So don't get me wrong. We need a revenue stream. But to do some convoluted auction way that you have no control over the price seems to be disingenuous. The other issue I have with the RIGI, it's a very expensive way to collect a tax.

[00:59:13] I'm a tax collector for the state of Virginia. 20 years ago or so, I used to get 3% to collect tax. But with the advent of computers, they cut me by 60%. So now I get to collect taxes, state of Virginia, take the liability of doing it and take the risk.

[00:59:33] And I get to keep about 1.3%, 1.2%. This auction house gets over 5% of what they do. They keep 5%.

[00:59:48] And to me, for what they do from where Dominion sends them, what they're buying for fake carbon credits to send back around is the wrong way to do it. If we need revenue, you need to stand up, grow a backbone, and vote for the tax.

[01:00:08] I hope we do not rejoin Reggie. Thank you. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:00:24] Ayes, 64, nose, 35. Ayes, 64, nose, 35. The bill passes. Over on page 16, we come to Senate Bill 824, Legislation Amendment and Reenact, Section of the Code of Virginia relating to School Board

Employee Grievance Procedure, Timing of Dispute Resolution, Legislation Report Committee on Education.

[01:00:44] Delegate from Hampton, Delegate Ward. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 824 is identical to my bill, House Bill 116, which passed this House 93 to 6. It's the bill that relates to the School Board Employee Grievance Procedure, and you may remember that we would not deduct a person's pay until they've heard had their case heard i move passage of the bill shall the bill pass circle close the roll ayes 94 nos 5. ayes 94 nos 5 the

[01:01:23] bill passes senate bill 788 uh now before you seeks to amend reenact two sections of the code of virginia relating to alcoholic beverage control payment of excise tax from beer wine coolers and Unwind. Penalties. Legislation reporting on finance with amendments. Delegate from Fairfax. Delegate Watts.

[01:01:39] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee's amendments. Shall the committee amendments be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendments would agree to. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Watts. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 788 clarifies the remittance of taxes on beer, wine, and wine coolers.

[01:01:58] It allows for the remittance to be postmarked rather than just received. It also clarifies the way in which the reports shall be made and also clarifies that if there is a delay in the first 30 days, that it is not the full 5% that would be collected on day or two or three, but allows for adjustment in the full 5% penalty.

[01:02:22] And finally, it changes the procedures for removing action against a licensee and to remove their license after they have paid all civil penalties and taxes due. I hope it will be the pleasure of the body to pass the bill.

[01:02:39] Shall the bill pass? I move that we pass Senate Bill 788. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the rolls.

[01:03:03] Ayes 91, no 6, abstentions 1. House 91, no 6, abstentions 1. The rest of you better not try that. She's been here a long time, so get away with that. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, we go pick up five bills that were moved. So returning to page 5, we come back to, and now before you, is Senate Bill 386.

[01:03:25] This is legislation to amend and reenact the Code of Virginia relating to owners of sewage treatment works, land application, marketing, or distribution of sewage sludge, perifluoroalkaline, and polyfluoroalkyl substances testing requirements, golly day, a reporter for the Committee on Agricultural Testing and Natural Resources with an amendment and a substitute, and the Chairman of ACNR, Delegate Lopez, has floor amendments that are drawn to the committee substitute.

[01:03:55] Delegate from Fredericksburg, Delegate Cole. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. May this bill go by for the day. that is from Fredericksburg, moves that the bill go by for the day. So he wanted to give you another chance to be able to pronounce these words appropriately. One more day of practice. All those in favor of moving SB 386 by for the day, say aye.

[01:04:13] Those opposed, no. 386 is by for the day. Over on page 6, we pick up Senate Bill 527. SB 527 seeks to amend the Code of Virginia Land and Pharmaceutical Substance Manufacturing Grant Fund, Legislation Reporting Committee on Appropriations.

[01:04:31] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. SB 527 is identical to my HB 1076, which passed this body 92 to 5. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:04:58] Ayes 92, no 6. Ayes 92, no 6. The bill passes. Over on page 7, we pick up Senate Bill 659, which seeks to amend the Code of Virginia Land and the Solar Interconnection Grant Program established. Report sunset.

[01:05:13] This legislation was for Committee on Appropriation. Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Herring. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 659 is the cognate to my House 683, which passed out of the chamber 85 to 13. Simply establishes the solar interconnection grant program that will be awarded to public bodies like localities and schools to connect to the grant.

[01:05:35] I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 84, noes 15.

[01:05:51] Ayes 84, noes 15. The bill passes. Over on page 8, bill before you next, is Senate Bill 729, which seeks to amend and re-enact tax code pertaining to private activity bonds, allocation of state ceiling, Legislation Report Committee on Appropriations.

[01:06:06] Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Thomas. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, Senate Bill 729 is identical to my House Bill 1227, which passed this chamber 92 to 6, if you want to remain consistent. All it does is changes the allocation of our private activity bonds by a factor of 10%, putting 3% towards local programs and 7% towards Virginia housing to create more affordable housing.

[01:06:26] I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 90, noes 8.

[01:06:43] Ayes 90, noes 8. The bill passes. And on page 9, last bill in this category, third reading regular, is Senate Bill 820, which seeks to amend and reenact Section of Dakota, Virginia, and portion of the Acts of Assembly of 2024 related to Community Builders Pilot Program, name change, sunset repeal.

[01:07:00] Legislation report including all appropriations with the amendment nature of substitute. The delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Russell. Mr. Speaker, move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. The delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Russell.

[01:07:15] Mr. Speaker, now this is identical to my House Bill 1153, which repeals the sunset on a very successful violence prevention program that's now in our middle schools. I hope it would be the pleasure of the body to pass the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:07:41] Ayes. 96, no's 2. House 96, no's 2. The bill passes. Continuing with today's calendar, we come to a new category, House bills, House bills with Senate amendments. A dozen and a half or so bills in this category, top of page 17.

[01:08:00] First up, House Bill 25, which relates to railroad safety, minimum train crew, movement of freight, civil penalties. Legislature passed the House, passed the Senate substitutes now before you. Delegate from Norfolk, Delegate Anthony. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that the House agree to the Senate substitute.

[01:08:17] And speaking to that substitute. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This substitute aligns with our Senate cognate, Senate Bill 191. This substitute comes from the SEC. It replaces the penalties with a reporting requirement. The SEC must include in its annual governor's report the

number of probable violations of this relevant federal regulation and that it would be investigated and referred to the Federal Railroad Administration.

[01:08:43] Mr. Speaker, there is peace in the valet. So I move that the body accepts the substitute and vote yes. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the row.

[01:09:05] Yes is 66. No's 33. You're supposed to say yes. 66. No's 33. The bill passes. Continuing with this category, next up is House Bill 84, relates to electric utilities and license suppliers of electricity, regional transmission entities, annual report.

[01:09:27] Legislature passed the House, House-Senate. That Senate substitutes now before you. Deli from Albemarle, Deli Loffer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 84 is a simple transparency bill to ensure that PJM is accountable to the ratepayers of Virginia. The Senate modified my bill.

[01:09:43] My bill passed 92 to 7, so I'd like to reject the Senate amendment, and I ask the body to vote no. Should a Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:10:06] Ayes, 2. Noes, 97. Ayes, 2. Noes, 97. The Senate substitute is rejected. Senate, excuse me, House Bill, House Bill 284, now before you, relates to electric utilities, high energy demand customers, state corporation commission to establish electric demand flexibility programs.

[01:10:25] Reports, legislation which will pass the House, substitute, pass the Senate with the substitute. Senate substitutes before you. Senator from Virginia Beach, Delegate Fagans. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'd like the House to agree to the Senate substitute, and I'd like to speak to the substitute. The delegate has the floor. The electric demand flexibility program bill remains the same with added guardrails.

[01:10:41] The Senate changes are technical, carve out our shipbuilders, clarify capacity reduction credits, align SEC timelines, and localized benefits, and work to protect our grid reliability. In its original form, this bill passed 97 to 0, 97 to 0, and again, I ask that we accept the Senate substitute and vote yes.

[01:11:00] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll. Yes. Ayes 98, noes 1. Ayes 98, noes 1.

[01:11:16] A Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 312, aye for the day. Therefore, top of page 18, legislation next before you is House Bill 369, which relates to electric utilities, renewable energy portfolio standard, zero carbon electricity, accelerated clean energy buyers.

[01:11:32] Legislation originally passed the House, passed Senate, Senate substitutes here before you now. Delegate Reed. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 369 amends the definition of zero-carbon electricity for purposes of renewable energy portfolio standard to include electricity generated by both fusion and nuclear energy.

[01:11:50] When this originally passed the House, it was 94-3, and it only applied to Phase 2 utilities. Now it comes back to us from the Senate and applies to both Phase 2 and Phase 1, and I ask the body to adopt the Senate substitute. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[01:12:09] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 95, noes, 4. Ayes, 95, noes, 4. The Senate's subject to be adopted. House Bill 434, HB 434, seeks to direct certain electric utilities petition to the State Corporation Commission for approval of electric grid utilization metrics.

[01:12:36] Legislation virtually passed the House, subsequently passed the Senate, and that's substituted by the Senate. It's now before you. Delegate LaVere Bowley. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'd like to move that we accept the Senate amendments in speaking to that motion. The Senate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 434 addresses energy affordability by prioritizing the use of our existing grid before building new infrastructure.

[01:12:56] The Senate amendments include strength in language and reflects consensus following conversations with some stakeholders. And with the substitute, the House and Senate bills will be identical. And with that, again, Mr. Speaker, I move that we accept and vote yes on the Senate amendments. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Circle close the row.

[01:13:21] Ayes 93, no's 4. Ayes 93, no's 4. The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 476, now before you, relates to a continuing care provider's meeting requirements. Legislation passed the House, subsequently passed Senate with a substitute, and that substitute is before you.

[01:13:38] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Watts. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 476 deals with the communication between the owners of continuing care communities and the residents. I am going to ask that we reject the Senate substitute. I believe we can work out a good compromise in conference.

[01:13:57] And unaccustomed as I am to being in the majority and being able to speak on bills that are actually continuing, I now move that we pass the Senate, substitute, and ask that the members vote no.

[01:14:13] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[01:14:26] Close the row. Ayes. Three. Noes. Ninety-six. Ayes. Three. Noes. Ninety-six. The Senate substitute is rejected. House Bill 484 relates to health insurance, ethics and fairness in carrier business practices, downcoded claims.

[01:14:45] Legislation originally passed the House, subsequently passed the Senate with the substitute that that is before you now. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Shen. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the Senate substitute in speaking to that. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The Senate substitute mirrors the House substitute that we put on top of SB 164, which will be before us on the uncontested block tomorrow.

[01:15:05] And the intent is to keep these bills identical as they continue to move through this process. The substitute before us now adds provisions that are consistent with CMS requirements on electric prior authorization, such as provider contracts to establish and maintain an electronic interface and ensuring electronic health record systems can be accessed on the aforementioned interface.

[01:15:25] Mr. Speaker, I move the Senate substitute and ask that my colleagues vote yes. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 98, noes 0.

[01:15:41] Ayes 98, noes 0. the substitute is adopted. Top of page 19, we come to House Bill 562, which relates to electric utilities, virtual power plant programs, cooperatives. Legislation passed the House, passed the Senate with the substitute, which is before you. Doug from Long County, Delegate Reed. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 562 originally passed its body 99 to 0, and this authorized electric cooperatives to establish and implement a virtual power plant program. I'm going to ask everyone to accept the Senate substitute, which now puts this in the same posture as Senate Bill 487, which we passed on Friday, which changes the word electric utility to electric cooperative

[01:16:18] 18 times in the legislation. So I move adoption of the Senate substitute. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[01:16:35] Close the roll. Ayes, 98. Noes, 1. Ayes, 98. Noes, 1. The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 625 now before you relates to health insurance limit on cost-sharing payments for prescription drugs under certain plans.

[01:16:51] Legislation originally passed the House, subsequently passed the Senate with the substitute, which is before you now. Della from Prince William, Doug at Hems. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 625 requires that at least 50% of the plans, or at least one plan of fewer than two, are offered at each metal level, provide a flat copay option for prescription drugs.

[01:17:08] Mr. Speaker, we're still trying to get peace in the Valley, so I move the committee substitute and ask that we vote no. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Doug will close the roll.

[01:17:28] Ayes. Ayes 2, noes 97. Ayes 2, noes 97. Senate substitute is rejected. House Bill 628 now before you relates to electric utilities, renewable energy portfolio, standard program requirements, power purchase agreements.

[01:17:44] Legislation originally passed the House, so it's passed the Senate with a substitute, which is before you. Then from Albemarle, Delegate Carlson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that the House agree to the Senate substitute, and speaking to that substitute, it conforms my bill to the Senate cognate. The underlying bill passes House 97 to 1.

[01:18:00] It's two technical fixes, and it strikes a reenactment clause because it's already captured in another bill and it's actually done better there. So with that, I move that we agree to the Senate substitute. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Troop will close the roll.

[01:18:23] Ayes 97, no's 1. Ayes 97, no's 1. The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 807 is legislation relating to electric utility, shared solar programs, Phase 2 utility. Legislation originally passed the House. Subtits passed the Senate with a substitute. That's seven substitutes before you.

[01:18:40] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB 807 expands Dominion's shared solar program. This bill passed the House 97 to 1. The Senate substitute simply addresses a drafting issue. I move the Senate substitute and ask that the body accept that substitute.

[01:18:57] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 90, nos 8. Ayes 90, nos 8.

[01:19:13] The Senate substitute is adopted. Over on page 19, we come to House Bill 828, which relates to electric utilities, a disconnection report, state corporation commission database, annual summary. Legislation originally passed the House, passed the Senate with the substitute, which is before you.

[01:19:30] Data from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 828 requires each investor-owned utility and electric co-op to provide monthly reports on residential customer disconnections to the state corporation commission. The substitute makes technical changes to the bill and allows electric utilities to put their numbers in context when reporting to the commission.

[01:19:52] I move the Senate substitute, and I ask the members to vote yes. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[01:20:07] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 98, no zero. Ayes 98, no zero. Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 1062 is legislation related to electric utilities, pilot program for electric energy conservation, generation, and storage. Orange legislation originally passed the House, subsequently passed the Senate with the substitute, which is before you.

[01:20:26] Doug from Norfolk, Doug Hernandez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. As a reminder, HB 1062 is the bill that will unlock up to $300 million in home energy upgrades to lower bills for families across the Commonwealth. The Senate substitute just aligns two different dates between the House and the Senate bill.

[01:20:42] It also makes two other technical changes, so I move the Senate substitute and ask that the body vote yes. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[01:20:58] Close the roll. Ayes 68, noes 31. Ayes 68, noes 31. The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 1102, not before you relates to renewable energy portfolio standard program, geothermal heating and cooling systems report.

[01:21:15] Legislation passed the House, passed the Senate with substitute, which is before you. Delegate from Mountain County, Delegate Singh. Mr. Speaker, this bill facilitates the adoption of geothermal heating and cooling. The Senate version has some technical changes. I move the substitute and request a yes vote.

[01:21:31] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 68, noes 31. Ayes 68, noes 31.

[01:21:47] Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 1342 would provide a charter for the city of Fairfax relating to city elections powers. Legislation is reported from the House, passed by the House, excuse me, and then passed the Senate with substitute, which is before you.

[01:22:03] From Fairfax, Delegate Bulliver. Mr. Speaker, thank you. HB 1342, a charter change for the City of Fairfax, passed this body 89 to 9, and has been conformed to SB 841. It does include everything that I wanted in 1341 and 1342.

[01:22:21] There's peace in the valley, and I move to adopt the Senate substitute. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:22:39] Ayes 93, noes 6. Ayes 93, noes 6. The Senate substitute is adopted. And then over on page 21, we come to House Bill 1487. This legislation relates to pilot program for underground transmission lines, qualifying projects, levy, report.

[01:22:59] Legislation originally passed the House. Subject passed Senate with a substitute. That amendment in a substitute is for you. The Delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Singh. Mr. Speaker, this bill creates a pilot program to bury transmission lines. We are still working through some differences, and we ought to go to conference. Therefore, I move the substitute and request that we vote no.

[01:23:15] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes. Seven, no's 92. Seven, no's 92. The Senate substitute is rejected.

[01:23:32] Continuing with today's calendar, we come on page 21 to the memorial resolution. The memorial resolution will be adopted in block or spread across pages 21 through 24, with the exception of House Joint Resolution 124, House Joint Resolution 170.

[01:23:54] Those two are out of the block. The rest of them are in the block. All those in favor of adopting the memorial resolution laid on the speaker's table is listed on pages 21 through 24, with the exceptions of those previously announced by the clerk, shall please rise. The resolution is agreed to.

[01:24:18] And category next, page 24, commending resolutions laid on the speaker's table. The commending resolutions adopted in block list on pages 24 through 31, with the exception of House Resolution 74, House Joint Resolution 135, House Joint Resolution 134, House Resolution 161 and House Resolution 184.

[01:24:41] The rest of the bills are in the block that's now before you. All those in favor of adopting the commending resolutions laid on the Speaker's table, found on pages 24 through 31 of the printed calendar, with the exception of those announced by the Clerk, will say aye. Aye.

[01:24:56] Those opposed, no. The resolution is agreed to. Mr. Speaker, the category on page 32, Senate bills in conference, House bills in conference, Just by way of reminder, this is the first one we've had. Conference reports, you know, the lead conferee is in charge.

[01:25:12] Bring them up. Once you bring them up, when they're ready to go, then we will take them up. So we do have our first conference report. It is by Delegate Bulova on page 33, a conference report for Senate Bill 581.

[01:25:28] SB 581, which provides a charter for the city of Fairfax relating to financial power, City Elections, Council of Powers. Would you like to take that up today? I kind of thought you did. The House will be at ease. The House, Senate Bill 581, the Congress report is received on this legislation raised to the Charter for the City of Fairfax related to Financial Powers, City Elections, Council Powers.

[01:26:06] The Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Boulevard. Mr. Speaker, thank you. This is the same as HB 1342, which we just discussed, and I move to accept the Conference Committee report. Shall the conference report be agreed to? Madam Clerk, close the roll.

[01:26:33] Ayes, 92, no, 6. Ayes, 92, no, 6. Conference report is agreed to. Mr. Speaker, with that, that completes today's calendar. Pursuing to House Rule 51, the House has returned to the morning hour. Does the Clerk have any additional announcements on communication?

[01:26:48] No communication. It's just simply the meeting scheduled for this afternoon, which is available online, looks like there are just two standing committees that will be meeting today. The Committee on Appropriations is meeting 15, 15 minutes upon adjournment of the House, approximately 1.30-ish.

[01:27:05] They'll be up, of course, on the 12th floor in the House Appropriations Committee Room, so that's just the full committee, no subs. And then 15 minutes upon adjournment of the House, the Committee for Courts of Justice will be meeting. They'll be down on the second floor in House Committee Room C, so appropriations and courts will be meeting.

[01:27:24] There are no other subcommittees or caucuses or other legislative activities that I'm aware of. Then looking ahead to tomorrow, March 3rd, the first caucus meeting will be at 7.30 for the Conservative Caucus. They will be in House Subcommittee Room 8 at 7.30.

[01:27:45] Then at 8 o'clock, the Committee on Education's K-12 subcommittee, they're going to be at 8 o'clock in House Committee Room A in the lower level. So, K-12 sub of Ed will be doing that at 8:00. Also at

8:00, the Transportation Committee's Department of Motor Vehicles subcommittee.

[01:28:05] They will be meeting, and they'll be in House Committee Room B. That meeting's at 8:00, and then once they're finished at 9:00, the full committee will continue on and work their docket. At 8:30 tomorrow, the full committee on Health and Human Services, they'll be meeting in House Committee Room C on the second level, second floor of the GAB.

[01:28:28] And with that, no other activities I'm aware of. And then we just come up to caucuses. The Democratic caucus will meet at 11.15 tomorrow, and the Republican caucus will meet at 11.30. We'll update that accordingly. The Democrats are in House Room 1, the Republicans in House Room 2.

[01:28:44] That's all the announcements that I have. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that when the House adjourns today, it adjourns to reconvene tomorrow at 12 noon. Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Heron moves up when the House adjourns today, adjourn to reconvene tomorrow at 12 noon. As many in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no.

[01:28:59] The motion is agreed to. The Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Heron. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House do now adjourn. Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Heron moves that the House do now adjourn. As many in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. The House adjourn to tomorrow at 12 noon.



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